

Teacher:	Ray Joshua Balingkit	**Subject:**	Design & Technology
Week:	13 (Term 1)	**Year:**	10–11
Link:		**Cover:**	

LESSON OVERVIEW

What should students know/do by the end of this week's lessons?

Students will research a design context and distinguish user evidence from assumptions. They will develop their understanding through a teacher explanation, a worked example and an evidence-based classroom task. In the second lesson, students will write a measurable design specification supported by user research. Their recorded reasoning, practical evidence and final checks will show whether they can apply the ideas to a defined user, product or design problem.

End-of-Week Assessment/Check: How will you know they got it?

Use teacher questioning, labelled diagrams, case comparisons and the completed independent tasks. Check accurate terminology, evidence linked to the user or brief and a reasoned explanation of choices. Review recorded tests or traces alongside conclusions, and use the final check in both lessons to identify the next skill needing practice.

LESSON SLOTS - TUESDAY AND WEDNESDAY

Lesson	Date	Learning Objective	The Lesson Flow	Differentiation
1	17 November 2026	By the end of this lesson, students will be able to research a design context and distinguish user evidence from assumptions.	**H:** Show a photograph of a cluttered shared desk and ask whether designing a larger storage box is already justified. List what is visible and what still needs to be asked. **ID:** Introduce context research through observation, product analysis and respectful user questions. Explain primary and secondary evidence, recording findings accurately and avoiding leading questions. Use a manageable school stationery context; collect no unnecessary personal information. **WD:** Model a short interview with a fictional user. Replace Do you want a bigger box with What is difficult when finding your stationery. Record a quoted need, an observed constraint and	**Support:** Provide a fictional user profile, interview stems and an evidence-assumption table. Model rewriting a leading question and allow oral rehearsal before the interview. **Extension:** Students identify conflicting findings and propose a further observation or question that could clarify which need should be prioritised.

			an unanswered question, then convert the findings into a focused problem statement. **YD:** Pairs plan three neutral questions, role-play a user interview using a supplied profile and analyse an existing product. Each student records findings in an evidence table, distinguishes assumptions and writes a design problem supported by at least two pieces of evidence. **C:** Check whether the problem statement identifies a user, difficulty and context without prescribing the final solution. Ask which question would most reduce the remaining uncertainty.	
2	18 November 2026	By the end of this lesson, students will be able to write a measurable design specification supported by user research.	**H:** Compare must look nice with must fit within the measured desk area. Ask which allows a finished product to be checked fairly and what evidence is needed to set a sensible limit. **ID:** Explain a specification as a set of justified requirements derived from research. Distinguish essential requirements from preferences and measurable criteria from vague statements. Cover function, dimensions, user access, materials, stability and appropriate classroom constraints without copying unsupported numbers. **WD:** Convert a fictional user's need to store six supplied pencils into a requirement and an acceptance test. Use the measured desk space to set a maximum footprint. Model a table with requirement, research	**Support:** Provide a specification table and examples of vague and measurable requirements. Help students convert one research finding into a testable point before they complete the remaining points independently. **Extension:** Students rank conflicting requirements, justify a trade-off and explain how the specification could support later concept selection without dictating a single design.



			reason, priority and test, and explain why decorative preferences need clearer criteria. **YD:** Students write six specification points for their researched stationery context, including at least four objectively testable requirements. They link each point to evidence and propose how it will be checked. Partners identify a vague or conflicting point and students revise it before submitting the specification. **C:** Ask students to demonstrate how a proposed test would produce a pass or fail for one essential requirement. Check that numerical limits come from measurement or the supplied brief and that criteria are achievable within the classroom context.	
3				Support: Extension:
4				Support: Extension:

MATERIALS NEEDED FOR THE WEEK

- Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1) Design and Technology revision notes: 1.13 Contexts which inform design outcomes; 1.16 Design strategies; 1.17 Developing and communicating design ideas
- Teacher computer, display screen and whiteboard markers
- Prepared product scenarios, diagrams and user briefs aligned to the lesson objectives
- Prepared analysis worksheet, comparison grid or test-recording table
- Paper, pencils, rulers, card templates and approved classroom stationery
- Teacher-prepared samples or component cards; pre-cut model parts where required
- Lesson success criteria, observation checklist and labelled evidence folders



END-OF-WEEK REFLECTION

- What worked well?

- What flopped or confused students?

- What needs to be re-taught or adjusted next week?